obsidian-mcp-router — quick reference

v0.56.1 · multi-vault Obsidian MCP server, shipped by its Claude Code plugin — one install = everything (47 slash commands · 42 MCP tools · 44 skills)
github.com/tboome33/obsidian-mcp-router

The router in 30 seconds

A single MCP process that knows **all your Obsidian vaults** (local + remote). Each tool takes a `vault` parameter (or uses the default). No more registering one MCP server per vault.

- **One plugin install = everything** (v0.56+): the Claude Code plugin ships *and launches* the server — declared in its root `.mcp.json` (key `router`, via `${CLAUDE_PLUGIN_ROOT}`). A manual `~/.claude.json` entry is the dev alternative; keeping both runs **two** server processes with duplicated tools (`mcp__obsidian-router__*` vs `mcp__plugin_obsidian-router_router__*`)
- **Local + remote vaults** treated identically — drop URL + API key into the config, done
- **Cross-vault**: `vault: "*"` auto-fans-out across every vault
- **Lock mode**: restrict the session to a single vault (safety, focus) · **Auto-enrichment**: Claude suggests wiki saves at 3 natural moments, 4 modes (`ClaudeAsk` / `Hybrid` / `FullAuto` / `off`)
- **Conversion toolbox** (v0.11+): PDF / DOCX / XLSX / PPTX / image (OCR) / audio / YouTube / webpage / git repo → markdown; opt-in **Docling** high-fidelity PDF + `pdf_to_images` (the model *sees* a PDF page); **BM25 relevance filter** (v0.47) strips off-topic blocks before synthesis
- **Knowledge graph**: typed graph JSON + reading tours + neighbors + shortest link path; export as `llms.txt` or **OKF bundle** (Google's Open Knowledge Format v0.1, with one of the ecosystem's first validators)
- **Click-to-open**: clickable links in chat via the bridge's `GET /open/<path>` route; `open_in_obsidian` does the same server-side (no browser — ideal for Claude Desktop)
- **Vault-creation wizard** (v0.35+): `plan_vault` → adjust → `provision_vault`, defaults-first (happy path = 1 interaction)
- **Multi-tenant mode** (v0.9+, opt-in): scope an instance by env vars — vault whitelist, read-only, per-user write audit — for MCPHub/proxy deployments
- **10 hooks**, split since v0.56: 2 come active with the plugin for every installer (hot-cache load + decisions recall); the other 8 (session auto-journal, wiki autocommit, link linter, doc-drift checker, update check, hot-cache guard…) are opt-in via `node scripts/setup-vault.mjs --install-hooks`

How the pieces fit — the dependency chain

```
Obsidian  ←  Local REST API (community plugin)  ←  BRIDGE (mcp-router-bridge,
v0.5.1)
    ↑ HTTP per vault (port + apiKey from the Local REST API plugin)
MCP SERVER (obsidian-mcp-router) — Node ≥ 20.18.1 process on the PC
    ↑ MCP over stdio, spawned by Claude Code
```

```
CLAUDE CODE PLUGIN (obsidian-router) — commands + skills + agents + hooks
    · since v0.56.1 the plugin SHIPS and LAUNCHES the server itself
```

- **Bridge** — runs *inside* Obsidian; registers extra routes on Local REST API's HTTP server (`/search/smart` , `/templates/execute` , `/open/*` , presence heartbeat). **Optional per vault**: without it, core file CRUD still works (plain Local REST API routes), but smart search, Templater execution and click-to-open links don't. Updates itself via BRAT from GitHub releases.
- **MCP server** — Node process spawned by Claude Code. Requires the **Local REST API** plugin in every vault (mandatory) and its registry at `~/.claude/obsidian-mcp-router/config.json` (maintained by `setup-vault.mjs`); the bridge is optional per vault (see above).
- **Claude Code plugin** — its commands and skills orchestrate the server's MCP tools; two hooks (hot-cache load, decisions recall) read vault files directly from disk.

Since v0.56.1 — the plugin ships the server: installing (or updating) the plugin installs (or updates) the server in the same move; fresh installs self-heal `node_modules` via a zero-dependency `bin/` bootstrapper. No `~/.claude.json` entry needed — that path remains for dev checkouts only (`claude --plugin-dir <checkout>` replaces the installed plugin for a session).

Vault setup

1. Have Node.js ≥ 20.18.1. Conversion backends are opt-in since v0.56 (npm `postinstall` was removed): `npm run install-markitdown` (needs Python 3.10+ on `PATH`), `npm run install-docling` — until installed, the conversion tools stay listed and return an actionable install hint
2. **Easiest path**: `/obsidian-router:meta-attach-vault` — interactive wizard that attaches a vault to a workspace (common case), bootstraps a standalone vault, or registers a remote one. Provisions plugins + scaffolds the wiki + binds `.env` + conventions picker.
3. CLI alternative:

   ```
   npm run setup-vault -- "C:\VAULTS\MyVault"
   ```

   ⇒ installs/configures **Local REST API** + bridge plugins, writes `.env` , allocates a unique port, adds to the registry. The 2 base hooks come active with the plugin; the 8 extra hooks are opt-**in** via `node scripts/setup-vault.mjs --install-hooks` .
4. Optional for `search_smart` : **Smart Connections** + **obsidian-mcp-router-bridge** · for Templater: **Templater**
5. Verify: `/obsidian-router:meta-status` or just say "*diagnose the router*"

Configuration — environment variables (workspace `.env`)

VAULT_PATH	Path of the current vault. Auto-detection: if it matches a registered vault, that vault becomes the default. Written by `setup-vault.mjs` .

`OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_DEFAULT_VAULT`	Explicit override of the default vault for this process. Wins over `VAULT_PATH` and over `config.defaultVault`. Also the workspace↔vault binding used by the wiki-query-first hooks.
`OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_LOCKED`	Locks the router to one vault for the session. Any tool call to another vault throws. Set via `/obsidian-router:lock <vault> --persist`.
`OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_AUTO_ENRICH`	Wiki auto-enrichment mode: `ClaudeAsk` (default) | `Hybrid` | `FullAuto` | `off`. Set via `/obsidian-router:auto-mode <Mode> --persist`.
`OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_ALLOWED_VAULTS`	Multi-tenant (v0.9+): comma-separated whitelist of vaults this instance sees. Others are skipped.
`OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_READONLY`	Multi-tenant: truthy (`1` / `true` / `yes` / `on`) hides the **11** write tools — write_file, append_to_file, patch_file, set_frontmatter, merge_frontmatter, move_file, delete_file, execute_template, download_page_assets, build_wiki_graph, provision_vault — filtered from ListTools AND refused at call time.
`OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_USER_ID`	Multi-tenant: audit trail — every successful write appends an attributed line to the vault's `wiki-meta/log.md`.
`VAULT_<NAME>`	A whole vault defined in one env var (JSON: `name`, `baseUrl`, `apiKey`…) — dashboard-editable on MCPHub deployments.
`OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_NO_WATCH`	Disables hot-reload of the config file (useful for debugging).
`OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_NO_HOT_CACHE_LOAD` · …`NO_DECISIONS_RECALL` · … `NO_WIKI_AUTOCOMMIT` · … `NO_SESSION_JOURNAL`	Per-hook opt-outs (v0.56): disable the hot-cache load, decisions recall, wiki autocommit and session journal hooks respectively. All accept `1` / `true` / `yes` / `on`.

Important files — where things live

`~/.claude/obsidian-mcp-router/config.json`	Main router config (vaults, port registry, defaultVault, disabledVaults, remoteVaults). Hot-reload enabled.
`~/.claude.json`	Manual/dev setup only: a hand-registered server entry pointing to a checkout. Since v0.56 the plugin declares its server in its own root `.mcp.json` (key `router`, `${CLAUDE_PLUGIN_ROOT}`); a hand-registered entry *plus* the plugin = two processes with duplicated tools (dev machines may keep both deliberately).
`~/.claude/settings.json`	The 8 opt-in hooks land here via `setup-vault.mjs --install-hooks` (the 2 base hooks ship active in the plugin's `hooks/hooks.json` — 10 hooks total). The plugin itself is

	enabled **per-workspace** via `<workspace>/.claude/settings.json` — 47 commands + 44 skills ≈ 10k context tokens, only load them where you use Obsidian.
`<workspace>/.env`	Environment variables for the current workspace (above). Auto-loaded at router boot.
`<vault>/CLAUDE.md`	Vault wiki consigne — loaded by Claude Code into context. Includes the auto-enrichment consigne (4 modes) + installed conventions.
`<vault>/wiki-meta/{index,log,hot,overview}.md`	Karpathy LLM-wiki scaffolds (catalog, append-only journal, hot cache, overview) — under `wiki-meta/` since v0.12 (user pages live under `wiki/`). Scaffolded by `/obsidian-router:wiki`.
`<vault>/wiki-meta/Sessions/`	Per-session detail journals (auto-written by the `session-auto-journal` hook; `log.md` stays a thin index).
`obsidian-mcp-router/docs/`	`auto-enrichment.md` (4 modes + 4 placement channels), `features/` (13 prose feature pages), `architecture.md`, this PDF (EN + FR).

47 slash commands /obsidian-router:<name> · auto-trigger on natural language (EN + FR)

🔧 16 MCP wrappers — one per core vault tool

Categories: `discover` · `read` · `write` · `manage` · `template` · `convert`

COMMAND	EFFECT	TRIGGER PHRASE (EN/FR)
`discover-list-vaults`	List vaults (online/latency/lock state)	"list my vaults" / "liste mes vaults"
`discover-list-files`	List files in a vault directory	"list files in Sessions" / "liste les fichiers de X"
`read-get`	Read a file (markdown + frontmatter)	"show me X" / "montre-moi X"
`read-search`	Plain-text (substring) search	"grep for <text>" / "trouve <texte>"
`read-search-smart`	Semantic search (Smart Connections)	"find notes about X" / "trouve mes notes sur X"
`read-frontmatter`	Read frontmatter (object or one key)	"metadata of X" / "quel est le statut de X"
`write-create-or-replace`	PUT — create or replace a file	"save this as X.md" / "crée une note X"
`write-append`	POST — append to a file	"append to my journal" / "ajoute à X"
`write-patch`	Surgical PATCH (heading/block/frontmatter)	"edit X section in Y" / "édite la section X dans Y"
`write-frontmatter-set`	Set one frontmatter key	"tag this with X" / "passe le statut de X à closed"
`write-frontmatter-merge`	Set multiple keys in sequence	"on X set status=closed outcome=tp1"
`manage-move`	Move or rename a file	"move X to Y" / "renomme X en Y"
`manage-delete`	Delete a file (2-step confirm guard)	"delete X" then "yes confirm=true"
`template-execute`	Execute a Templater template	"run X template" / "rends Templates/X.md avec arg=v"

`pdf-to-markdown`	Local PDF → markdown (MarkItDown, fast plain-text)	"convert this PDF to markdown" / "convertis ce PDF"
`pdf-to-markdown-docling`	High-fidelity PDF → markdown (Docling, tables/layout, opt-in)	"convert with docling" / "conversion haute fidélité"

🔒 3 router-state commands (lock + auto-enrichment)

COMMAND	EFFECT	TRIGGER PHRASE (EN/FR)
`lock`	Restrict the session to one vault (volatile or `--persist`)	"I only want to work on X" / "verrouille sur X"
`unlock`	Lift the lock, restore multi-vault routing	"unlock vaults" / "déverrouille les vaults"
`auto-mode`	Set the auto-enrichment mode (ClaudeAsk / Hybrid / FullAuto / off)	"switch to Hybrid mode" / "passe en mode Hybrid"

🩺 7 conversational helpers (setup + diagnostic)

COMMAND	EFFECT	TRIGGER PHRASE (EN/FR)
`meta-setup`	Manual/dev install (clone + npm link + `~/.claude.json` entry) — normal installs get the server from the plugin since v0.56	"setup obsidian-mcp-router" / "installe le router"
`meta-attach-vault`	Wizard — attach a vault to a workspace (common), standalone, or remote	"attach a vault to this workspace" / "connecte mon vault distant"
`meta-status`	Health-check every vault with fix hints	"are my vaults reachable" / "diagnostique le router"
`meta-sync-template`	Propagate the reference vault's plugins/snippets/docs to vaults (picker)	"sync the template to all vaults" / "synchronise le template"
`sync-from-github`	Update one vault or the whole fleet straight from the GitHub skeleton (plugins, themes, snippets, docs) — no local dev repo needed	"sync my vaults from github" / "mets à jour depuis GitHub"
`meta-audit-bridge-readiness`	Audit click-to-open readiness (bridge, REST API, HTTP, live /open probe)	"is click-to-open ready" / "audite le bridge"

`conventions`	Install/remove/status/propagate CLAUDE.md conventions cross-vaults	"install source-type on X" / "installe la convention X"

📚 21 knowledge-management commands (Karpathy-style LLM-wiki)

COMMAND	EFFECT	TRIGGER PHRASE (EN/FR)
`wiki`	Scaffold the wiki in a vault (index, log, hot, overview)	"set up a wiki" / "scaffold un wiki"
`wiki-ingest`	Ingest a source → entity/concept pages + cross-refs	"absorb this article" / "ingère cette URL"
`wiki-query`	3-tier RAG over the wiki (no web)	"what does my wiki say about X" / "d'après mes notes …"
`wiki-lint`	Health check (orphans, dead links, index drift)	"audit my wiki" / "lint le wiki"
`wiki-fold`	Idempotent log rollup under wiki/folds/	"fold the log" / "compacte le journal"
`hot-compact`	Compact an oversized hot.md back to its cache contract (verified backup first)	"compact the hot cache" / "compacte le hot"
`save`	File the conversation as a typed wiki note (session/decision/ADR/...)	"save this" / "sauvegarde ça"
`decision-consolidate`	Compress a settled decision page to its essentials; move the full deliberation history to a verified archive note	"consolidate this decision" / "consolide cette décision"
`autoresearch`	Autonomous web→synth→file loop	"research X online" / "fais une recherche web sur X"
`canvas`	Create/edit Obsidian .canvas files	"create a canvas for X" / "crée un canvas pour X"
`defuddle`	Strip noise from web pages before ingestion	"defuddle <url>" / "nettoie cette page"
`obsidian-bases`	Create/edit Obsidian .base files (database views)	"create a base for X" / "crée une base pour X"
`wiki-graph`	Build the typed knowledge-graph JSON → `wiki-meta/graph/` + an `.understand-anything/` copy for the Understand-Anything dashboard (deterministic, no LLM)	"build the wiki graph" / "construis le graphe"

`wiki-tour`	Ordered pedagogical reading tour from the link topology	"give me a tour of this vault" / "par où je commence"
`wiki-neighbors`	One page's neighbors — links out, backlinks, or both	"what links to X" / "voisins de X"
`wiki-path`	Shortest link chain between two pages	"how is X connected to Y" / "quel rapport entre X et Y"
`wiki-export`	Export the vault as llms.txt / llms-full.txt or an OKF bundle	"export the wiki as llms.txt" / "exporte le wiki"
`okf-export`	Export a wiki subset as a shareable OKF v0.1 bundle (conformance self-checked)	"export this folder as an OKF bundle" / "publie en bundle OKF"
`okf-check`	Validate any OKF bundle against the v0.1 conformance rules	"validate this OKF bundle" / "ce bundle est-il conforme ?"
`wiki-refresh-digests`	Regenerate per-page digest sidecars (concepts/claims/keywords)	"refresh the digests" / "rafraîchis les digests"
`who-is-speaking`	Identify the family member in a shared vault, lock routing per member	"who is speaking" / "c'est Karine"

The 42 MCP tools — what Claude actually calls under the hood

`list_vaults` · `list_files`	**Discovery.** Vault catalog with online status + latency (call first); directory listing.
`get_file` · `search` · `search_smart` · `get_frontmatter`	**Reads.** Full file; substring search; semantic search (Smart Connections embeddings, cosine scores); typed frontmatter. `vault: "*"` = cross-vault fan-out.
`write_file` · `append_to_file` · `patch_file` · `delete_file` · `set_frontmatter` · `merge_frontmatter` · `move_file`	**Writes & file management.** Create/replace; append; surgical patch by heading/block/frontmatter; guarded delete (`confirm: true`); one or many frontmatter keys; move/rename.
`execute_template`	**Templater.** Render a template, optionally write the result; args via `tp.mcpTools.prompt("key")` .
`lock_vault` · `unlock_vaults` · `set_auto_enrich_mode`	**Router state.** Single-vault isolation; auto-enrichment mode switch.
`plan_vault` · `provision_vault`	**Vault provisioning** (v0.35+). Read-only plan (defaults + questionnaire + warnings) → one-call creation (plugins, port, API key, wiki scaffold, registry). Local-only.
`pdf/docx/xlsx/pptx/image/audio_to_markdown`	**Local conversion** (MarkItDown — opt-in via `npm run install-markitdown` since v0.56; the tools stay listed and return an install hint when the backend is missing). Office/PDF/image OCR/audio transcription → markdown text; chain with `write_file` .
`pdf_to_markdown_docling` · `pdf_to_images`	**High-fidelity PDF** (opt-in Docling): layout + table-structure recognition. `pdf_to_images` renders pages to PNG so the model can *see* them (capped pages/bytes).
`youtube/bing_search/webpage_to_markdown` · `git_repo_to_markdown`	**Remote conversion.** URL → markdown (SSRF-guarded); YouTube transcripts; git repo → single markdown bundle (repomix, optional Tree-sitter compression). `webpage_to_markdown` accepts `relevanceQuery` (BM25).
`filter_relevant_blocks`	**Relevance filter** (v0.47). Deterministic BM25 second pass over markdown you already have — drops off-topic blocks, keeps frontmatter/headings, multiple no-op safety nets. No fetch, no LLM.
`extract_page_metadata` · `propose_linked_sources` · `download_page_assets`	**Web ingestion support.** Deterministic page metadata (JSON-LD/OpenGraph); scored link-following candidates; image download into the vault.

`get_wiki_context_pack` · `build_wiki_graph` · `build_wiki_tour` · `get_page_neighbors` · `wiki_path`	**Context & graph.** Structured context envelope for external agents; typed knowledge graph; reading tours; per-page neighbors; shortest link path.
`build_open_link` · `open_in_obsidian`	**Navigation.** Ready-to-paste click-to-open links; server-side open (raise Obsidian window, optional heading anchor) — no browser round-trip.

Tips · Type `/obsidian-router:` in Claude Code → autocomplete · Every command accepts a `vault` argument (wrappers fall back to the default) · `vault: "*"` on `search` / `search_smart` = cross-vault fan-out · Trigger phrases are indicative — Claude recognizes variants · Write results carry a ready-made `clickToOpenUrl` — one click opens the note in Obsidian · Full docs: `README.md`, `docs/features/` (13 pages), `docs/auto-enrichment.md` in the repo.